

Sorted Platform - Master Product & Technical Specification (V1)

1. Platform Vision

Sorted is a multi-brand home services platform designed around:

- subscription-based recurring services
- AI-assisted operations
- managed marketplace workforce distribution
- centralized customer relationship ownership
- scalable multi-brand architecture

The first launch brand will be:

- GardensSorted

Future brands may include:

- CleaningSorted
- RepairsSorted
- WindowsSorted
- other home service verticals

The long-term vision is for customers to have:

- one Sorted account
- one payment relationship
- one property profile
- access to multiple services/brands

The core backend platform must remain:

- brand agnostic
 - service agnostic
 - operationally centralized
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2. Business Model

Commercial Model

Sorted acts as:

- lead generation platform
- workflow orchestration platform
- managed marketplace operator

- subscription management provider
- customer relationship owner

Sorted does NOT directly perform services. Providers are:

- self-employed contractors
- assigned or claim jobs
- paid by Sorted
- managed operationally through the platform

Revenue Model

Primary revenue:

- recurring customer subscriptions

Future revenue opportunities:

- provider tools/services
- upsells/cross-sells
- one-off services
- premium subscription tiers
- annual plans

Initial Geography

Launch region:

- Yorkshire, UK

Expansion must be supported later.

3. Core Product Principles

Key Principles

1. Low Friction Customer Signup

Customer onboarding must be:

- fast
- simple
- mobile friendly
- conversion optimized

Initial signup should require minimal information. Additional information can be collected later.

2. Subscription First

The platform is optimized primarily around recurring services. One-off jobs may be introduced later.

3. AI-Assisted Operations

AI agents should eventually handle:

- customer support
- workflow orchestration
- communication drafting
- scheduling recommendations
- provider coordination
- churn prevention
- anomaly detection

Human admins act primarily as:

- orchestrators
- escalation handlers
- exception managers

4. Centralized Customer Ownership

Customers primarily communicate through Sorted. Direct provider/customer communication should be minimized.

5. Operational Simplicity First

The MVP should prioritize:

- operational efficiency
- provider liquidity
- recurring revenue
- low admin overhead

4. User Types

Customer

Customers can:

- browse services
- subscribe
- manage billing
- manage subscriptions
- communicate with support
- upload property photos
- view visits

- manage preferences

Customers should eventually:

- access all brands from one account
- receive cross-sell offers

Provider

Providers are self-employed contractors.

Providers can:

- onboard to platform
- join locality groups
- claim work
- manage availability
- view earnings
- view assigned recurring customers
- communicate with operations

Providers initially communicate primarily through:

- WhatsApp

Minimal provider dashboard initially.

Internal Admin

Internal staff can:

- manage operations
- oversee workflows
- intervene in escalations
- monitor AI actions
- manage providers
- manage subscriptions
- manage customers
- monitor KPIs

5. Service Model

Initial Service

GardensSorted will initially focus on:

- recurring gardening subscriptions

Likely services include:

- lawn mowing
- hedge trimming
- general maintenance
- seasonal tidy-ups

Detailed service catalog to be defined later.

Scheduling Model

Customers select:

- availability windows NOT exact appointment times.

Higher subscription tiers may allow:

- tighter scheduling windows
- preferred visit times

Recurring services should ideally remain with the same provider.

Weather Considerations

The platform must support:

- weather-aware scheduling
 - rescheduling workflows
 - weather disruption communications
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6. Subscription Model

Initial Subscription Structure

Recurring subscriptions only for MVP.

Future support:

- one-off jobs
- minimum spend requirements

Subscription Terms

Monthly Plans

- minimum 3-month commitment
- monthly billing

Annual Plans

- discounted pricing
- fixed 12-month commitment

Customer Cancellation

Customers must contact support to cancel.

No self-service cancellation in MVP.

7. Provider Marketplace Model

Claiming Logic

Provider job assignment initially uses:

- first come first served

Constraints:

- no double booking
- travel time validation
- territory validation
- locality optimization

Locality Model

Providers grouped by:

- local geographic areas

Initial communication/distribution may use:

- locality-based WhatsApp groups

The platform database remains the source of truth.

Provider Performance

Providers are rated internally.

Metrics may include:

- reliability
- punctuality
- completion quality
- customer satisfaction

- claim response speed
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8. Customer Experience Flow

Signup Flow

Initial signup should capture:

- name
- email
- phone
- address
- postcode
- rough garden size
- subscription tier
- payment method
- availability preference

Optional enrichment later:

- photos/videos
- access instructions
- pets
- gate codes
- special notes

Payment Flow

Customers pay:

- at signup

Future support:

- retries
 - dunning workflows
 - failed payment handling
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9. Technology Strategy

Architecture Style

Recommended architecture:

- modular monolith

Avoid microservices initially.

Reasoning:

- lower complexity
- lower infrastructure cost
- faster development
- easier AI-assisted generation
- simpler deployments

Core Backend Stack

Backend

- .NET 9
- ASP.NET Core Web API
- EF Core

Frontend

- Next.js
- React
- Tailwind

Mobile

Initial approach:

- responsive web app

Future:

- mobile app wrapper or native app

Database Strategy

Development:

- SQLite supported

Production initial options:

- PostgreSQL
- SQL Server Express

Schema design should remain:

- SQL Server compatible

Hosting Strategy

Initial low-cost hosting preferred.

Potential providers:

- Hetzner
- DigitalOcean
- Railway

Avoid deep Azure dependency initially.

Azure migration readiness should be maintained.

10. Recommended Future Azure Migration Path

Future scalable architecture may include:

Database

- Azure SQL

Hosting

- Azure App Services
- Azure Container Apps

Messaging

- Azure Service Bus

File Storage

- Azure Blob Storage

Analytics

- Synapse
- Microsoft Fabric

Secrets

- Azure Key Vault
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11. Core Platform Modules

Identity Module

Responsibilities:

- authentication
- authorization
- customer login
- provider login
- admin login
- multi-brand identity

Brands Module

Responsibilities:

- brand configuration
- themes
- domains
- brand-specific content

Customers Module

Responsibilities:

- customer profiles
- property details
- preferences
- support history

Providers Module

Responsibilities:

- onboarding
- territories
- skills
- availability
- ratings
- payouts

Services Module

Responsibilities:

- service catalog
- pricing rules
- subscription rules

Subscription Module

Responsibilities:

- recurring billing
- plan management
- renewals
- commitment tracking

Scheduling Module

Responsibilities:

- recurring visits
- availability windows
- weather adjustments
- provider allocation

Dispatch Module

Responsibilities:

- provider claiming
- territory matching
- dispatch workflows
- assignment validation

CRM Module

Responsibilities:

- operational dashboard
- customer support
- provider management
- escalations

Communications Module

Responsibilities:

- email
- SMS
- WhatsApp integrations
- notifications
- communication logs

AI Orchestration Module

Responsibilities:

- AI support assistant
- workflow recommendations
- AI escalation routing
- automation approvals

Billing Module

Responsibilities:

- customer payments
- invoices
- provider payouts
- accounting exports

Analytics Module

Responsibilities:

- recurring revenue
- churn
- provider utilization
- operational metrics

Workflow Engine Module

Responsibilities:

- state transitions
- automation triggers
- operational orchestration
- event handling

12. Database Design Direction

Key Principles

Database must support:

- multi-brand architecture
- future scalability
- operational auditability
- AI workflow analysis
- recurring scheduling

- provider assignment history

Likely Core Entities

Platform Entities

- Users
- Roles
- Permissions
- Brands

Customer Entities

- Customers
- CustomerProperties
- CustomerPreferences
- CustomerSubscriptions

Service Entities

- Services
- ServiceCategories
- SubscriptionPlans
- PricingRules

Operations Entities

- Jobs
- JobVisits
- VisitSchedules
- DispatchOffers
- WorkflowEvents

Provider Entities

- Providers
- ProviderTerritories
- ProviderSkills
- ProviderAvailability
- ProviderRatings

Communication Entities

- Messages
- Notifications
- CommunicationThreads

Financial Entities

- Payments
- Invoices
- ProviderPayouts
- Refunds

AI Entities

- AIInteractions
- AIRecommendations
- AIActionLogs
- Escalations

Audit Entities

- AuditLogs
 - EntityHistory
 - WorkflowStateTransitions
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13. Workflow Engine Requirements

The workflow engine is a core platform component.

Example workflows:

- customer signup
- payment success
- subscription creation
- recurring visit generation
- provider dispatch
- provider claim
- customer notifications
- reminder sequences
- weather disruption handling
- completion confirmation
- payout generation
- churn prevention sequences

All workflow transitions should be logged.

14. AI Support Strategy

Initial AI Support

Customer-facing AI support should exist from day one.

Initial AI responsibilities:

- FAQ responses
- account assistance
- schedule information
- escalation triage
- subscription guidance

Human Escalation

AI should escalate:

- disputes
- cancellations
- edge cases
- provider complaints
- billing issues

AI Governance

System should support:

- confidence scoring
 - audit logging
 - approval workflows
 - human overrides
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15. Communications Strategy

Customer Communication Channels

- website live chat
- email
- SMS

Provider Communication Channels

Primarily:

- WhatsApp

Future:

- provider portal notifications
- mobile app notifications

Communication Logging

All communications should be centrally logged.

16. Operational KPIs

Primary early KPIs:

- recurring revenue
 - churn
 - provider utilization
 - claim speed
 - completion rate
 - customer retention
 - locality profitability
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17. Future Features

Future Customer Features

- cross-brand services
- referrals
- self-service upgrades
- one-off services
- loyalty/rewards

Future Provider Features

- route planning
- earnings forecasting
- advanced scheduling
- mobile app
- performance insights

Future Platform Features

- AI dispatch optimization
 - predictive churn modeling
 - automated territory balancing
 - dynamic pricing
 - AI scheduling optimization
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18. MVP Priorities

MUST HAVE

- customer signup
- subscription billing
- provider onboarding

- provider job claiming
- operational CRM
- recurring scheduling
- customer support chat
- payment processing
- communications logging

SHOULD HAVE

- AI support assistant
- provider dashboard
- weather-aware workflows
- internal analytics

LATER PHASES

- native mobile apps
- advanced AI orchestration
- route optimization
- cross-brand recommendations
- one-off jobs
- advanced analytics
- predictive automation

19. Open Decisions / To Define

The following still require detailed specification:

- exact subscription tiers
- pricing model
- garden sizing logic
- provider payout formulas
- SLA definitions
- communication tone/branding
- exact AI stack
- payment provider
- dispatch prioritization rules
- weather rescheduling rules
- referral mechanics
- provider contracts
- legal/compliance requirements
- accounting integrations
- VAT handling
- customer notification timings
- territory definitions